

GED Social Studies Practice Test 14

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC14-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires lawmakers to review “tax expenditures,” such as exemptions, deductions, and credits, in the same budget cycle as direct spending programs. Supporters argue that reducing tax revenue has a budget effect similar to spending public money, so these policies should be examined regularly.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this requirement?

- A) Treating tax breaks as part of fiscal oversight
- B) Giving courts authority to collect income taxes
- C) Allowing agencies to spend without legal approval
- D) Preventing the legislature from reviewing revenue policy

GED-SOC14-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country compares two imported products after a tariff is added.

Product: Steel panels, Solar batteries

Pre-tariff price per unit: \$500, \$800

Tariff per unit: \$75, \$40

Domestic producers competing with imports: Many, Few

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Steel panels have the higher tariff as a share of pre-tariff price.
- B) Solar batteries have the higher tariff as a share of pre-tariff price.
- C) Both products have the same tariff as a share of pre-tariff price.
- D) Neither product is affected by the tariff.

GED-SOC14-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late 1800s, some African American educators promoted industrial and agricultural training as a path to economic independence. Others argued that classical education, voting rights, and legal

equality were essential for full citizenship. Both approaches responded to segregation and limited opportunity.

Which issue is most clearly reflected in the source?

- A) Debate over strategies for advancement under segregation
- B) Debate over whether the United States should purchase Alaska
- C) Conflict over building canals in the early republic
- D) Disagreement over radio entertainment in the 1920s

GED-SOC14-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A described map shows a mountainous country with one major north-south highway. Most factories are located in a central valley where the highway crosses two rivers. Smaller villages in high mountain areas rely on pack animals and seasonal roads.

Which geographic factor best explains why factories cluster in the central valley?

- A) Easier transportation and access to water routes
- B) Complete isolation from markets
- C) Greater difficulty moving goods through valleys
- D) Absence of rivers and roads

GED-SOC14-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state requires independent actuarial reviews before changing public retirement benefits. The review must estimate how the change would affect future pension obligations and contributions from employees and taxpayers.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic purpose of this requirement?

- A) It helps officials understand long-term financial effects before changing benefits.
- B) It connects retirement policy to obligations paid over time.
- C) It gives pension funds authority to declare criminal penalties.
- D) It prevents taxpayers from receiving any budget information.
- E) It allows courts to replace the legislature in setting all wages.

GED-SOC14-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A federal official supports national rules for online privacy because companies collect data from users in many states. The official argues that one national standard would reduce confusion and protect people no matter where they live.

Source B:

A state attorney general argues that states should be allowed to create stronger privacy protections when residents face new risks. The official says state laws can respond quickly when national rules are delayed or too weak.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether online privacy rules should be nationally uniform or allow stronger state action
- B) Whether internet companies should replace state courts
- C) Whether states may issue passports to website users
- D) Whether privacy laws should apply only to foreign governments

GED-SOC14-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the late 1800s, many Chinese immigrants worked in mining, railroad construction, agriculture, and small businesses in the West. Economic competition and racial prejudice led to violence and calls for exclusion. Federal laws later restricted immigration from China.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by this source?

- A) Immigration contributed to labor and community development while also provoking discrimination and exclusion
- B) Chinese immigrants were not involved in western economic life
- C) Federal immigration restrictions were unrelated to racial prejudice
- D) Economic competition ended all anti-immigrant sentiment

GED-SOC14-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A federal court may hear a case involving citizens of different states under [D1], while state courts generally handle most disputes involving [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) diversity jurisdiction | naturalization | appropriation

D2) state law claims | foreign treaties only | presidential appointments

GED-SOC14-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A family has a credit card balance of \$1,500. The monthly interest rate is 2%. If the family makes no payment for one month, how many dollars of interest will be added?

Type your answer as a dollar amount without the dollar sign.

GED-SOC14-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country discovers offshore natural gas reserves. The coastal region expects jobs at ports and processing facilities, while inland regions ask for a share of the revenue to fund schools and roads. National leaders debate how resource income should be distributed.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Natural resource wealth can create debates over regional distribution of revenue.
- B) Offshore resources benefit only farmers in inland regions.
- C) Resource income never affects public spending decisions.
- D) Coastal regions cannot participate in energy production.

GED-SOC14-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state allows tribal governments and state agencies to negotiate agreements about emergency services on roads that cross reservation boundaries. The agreements identify which responders arrive first, how costs are shared, and how communication will work.

Which civic issue is most clearly shown?

- A) Intergovernmental coordination across overlapping jurisdictions
- B) State authority to abolish tribal governments
- C) Private control of public emergency services
- D) Federal courts writing every local road policy

GED-SOC14-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows enrollment at historically Black colleges in one region.

Year: 1920, 1940, 1960

Enrollment: 18,000, 42,000, 96,000

Number of institutions: 24, 31, 38

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Enrollment increased faster than the number of institutions.

- B) The number of institutions decreased after 1920.
- C) Enrollment was highest in 1920.
- D) Enrollment and institutions both stayed the same.

GED-SOC14-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution lets the legislature create regional water authorities when a watershed crosses city and county boundaries. These authorities may coordinate treatment plants, conservation rules, and drought planning, but their powers must be listed in state law.

Which statement best describes this arrangement?

- A) Regional public bodies may be created to manage services that cross local boundaries.
- B) Water authorities may operate without any legal limits.
- C) Counties may conduct foreign water treaties without state approval.
- D) Cities must stop providing all water services.

GED-SOC14-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country exports copper and imports most of its medical equipment. When copper prices rise, government revenue from mining royalties increases. At the same time, a weaker national currency makes imported medical equipment more expensive.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) A country can benefit from one global price change while being hurt by another trade-related cost.
- B) Export prices and exchange rates never affect public budgets.
- C) Imported medical equipment becomes cheaper when currency weakens.
- D) Mining royalties have no connection to government revenue.

GED-SOC14-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution says that counties may not create criminal penalties unless the legislature has clearly given them that authority. Counties may pass local rules about certain services, but punishment for crimes must be authorized by state law.

Which civic principle is most directly reflected?

- A) Local governments have only the legal powers granted to them

- B) Counties may create any criminal law they choose
- C) Criminal law is written only by private businesses
- D) State legislatures cannot limit county authority

GED-SOC14-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the 1970s, disability rights activists organized sit-ins, lawsuits, and public campaigns to demand access to schools, transportation, workplaces, and public buildings. Activists argued that physical barriers and discriminatory policies excluded people from full participation.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Disability rights activism connected civil rights claims to access in everyday public life.
- B) Activists used legal and public-pressure strategies to seek policy change.
- C) Disability rights activism focused only on foreign military policy.
- D) Physical access had no connection to participation in society.
- E) Public transportation was never part of disability rights concerns.

GED-SOC14-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region compares land and population.

Area: River plain, Hill country, Coastal strip

Land area: 40,000 sq mi, 70,000 sq mi, 10,000 sq mi

Population: 8 million, 3.5 million, 5 million

Which area has the highest population density?

- A) River plain
- B) Hill country
- C) Coastal strip
- D) River plain and hill country equally

GED-SOC14-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state requires large public contracts to include performance benchmarks, such as completion dates and service-quality measures. If the contractor misses benchmarks without a valid reason, the state may reduce payments.

Which conclusion is best supported by this policy?

- A) Contract rules can link public payments to measurable results.
- B) Public contracts may never include performance standards.
- C) Contractors may decide how much public money they receive.
- D) Governments cannot purchase services from private companies.

GED-SOC14-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city compares two options for financing a water project.

Option: 10-year bond, 20-year bond

Annual payment: \$4.4 million, \$2.8 million

Total interest paid: \$6 million, \$16 million

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The 20-year bond has lower annual payments but higher total interest.
- B) The 10-year bond has higher total interest than the 20-year bond.
- C) Both bonds have the same annual payment.
- D) The 20-year bond has no interest cost.

GED-SOC14-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

When a state constitution allows citizens to sue the state only under conditions set by law, it reflects [D1]. When the state consents to be sued for certain claims, it creates [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) sovereign immunity | gerrymandering | naturalization

D2) a limited waiver | a criminal indictment | a foreign alliance

GED-SOC14-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A public health program has three funding sources.

Source: Federal funds, State funds, County funds

Amount: \$18 million, \$12 million, \$10 million

What percent of the program's funding comes from federal funds?

- A) 30%
- B) 40%

- C) 45%
- D) 60%

GED-SOC14-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires counties to provide certain public health services, but it allows counties to choose whether to operate clinics directly, contract with nonprofit providers, or share services with neighboring counties.

Which statement best describes this state-local relationship?

- A) The state sets required outcomes while counties choose among approved methods.
- B) Counties may ignore all state public health requirements.
- C) Nonprofit providers become state legislatures.
- D) Public health services cannot be delivered locally.

GED-SOC14-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A coastal shipping route takes 9 days. A longer route around a conflict zone takes 14 days. How many additional days does the longer route require?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC14-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1980s and 1990s, hip-hop music, dance, fashion, and visual art spread from local urban neighborhoods to national and global audiences. Artists often addressed community life, economic inequality, policing, and identity.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by the source?

- A) Local cultural expression can spread widely while carrying social commentary.
- B) Hip-hop remained limited to one neighborhood and had no social themes.
- C) Global audiences prevented American cultural forms from spreading.
- D) Music and art cannot reflect social conditions.

GED-SOC14-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Sovereign immunity
- B) Regional authority
- C) Performance benchmark
- D) Diversity jurisdiction

Targets:

- T1) A public body created to coordinate services across local boundaries
- T2) A measurable requirement used to evaluate contract performance
- T3) A rule affecting when a government may be sued

GED-SOC14-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A producer signs contracts to buy wheat from three countries instead of relying on one supplier.

The company says the strategy may cost slightly more but reduces the risk that drought or political conflict in one country will stop production.

Which economic idea is most clearly shown?

- A) Diversifying suppliers can reduce supply-chain risk.
- B) Buying from more suppliers always eliminates all costs.
- C) International sourcing prevents businesses from producing goods.
- D) Political conflict never affects supply chains.

GED-SOC14-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state constitution creates a public lands trust. Revenue from leasing certain public lands must support public schools, and officials must manage the lands for long-term benefit rather than short-term private gain.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

- A) Managing public assets for a designated public purpose
- B) Allowing officials to transfer public lands for personal benefit
- C) Replacing school funding with private gifts only
- D) Preventing the state from managing public land

GED-SOC14-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court reviews a city fee charged to new developments for road improvements. The court says the fee is valid only if it is reasonably related to the traffic impact caused by the new development.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Local fees on development should be connected to the public costs created by that development.
- B) Cities may charge any fee without a connection to public costs.
- C) Road improvements cannot be funded by local governments.
- D) Courts may not review development fees under any standard.

GED-SOC14-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the late twentieth century, many older industrial cities invested in museums, universities, medical centers, and waterfront redevelopment. These efforts reflected a shift toward [D1] after losses in [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) service- and knowledge-based economies | plantation agriculture | colonial taxation

D2) traditional manufacturing employment | western land claims | early canal tolls

GED-SOC14-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county transportation fund receives \$48 million. It spends \$20 million on bridges, \$14 million on bus routes, and \$6 million on bike lanes.

How much money remains in the fund?

- A) \$6 million
- B) \$8 million
- C) \$14 million
- D) \$40 million

GED-SOC14-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state allows local governments to form joint purchasing cooperatives. Through a cooperative, several towns can buy road salt, emergency equipment, or software together at lower prices than each town could get alone.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this arrangement?

- A) Helping local governments reduce costs by cooperating on purchases
- B) Allowing towns to conduct foreign trade policy

- C) Replacing local governments with private stores
- D) Preventing towns from buying public supplies

GED-SOC14-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state compares road funding needs.

Region: Mountain, Plains, Metro

Lane miles: 8,000, 12,000, 5,000

Average repair cost per lane mile: \$90,000, \$45,000, \$120,000

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Metro has the highest repair cost per lane mile.
- B) Plains has the greatest number of lane miles.
- C) Mountain has the lowest repair cost per lane mile.
- D) Metro has the greatest number of lane miles.
- E) Plains and Metro have the same repair cost per lane mile.

GED-SOC14-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A described map shows three ports connected by sea lanes to factories in several countries. One port specializes in container cargo, another in oil tankers, and the third in refrigerated food shipments. Nearby cities have grown around each port's specialized services.

Which conclusion is best supported by the described map?

- A) Port specialization can shape nearby urban economies.
- B) All ports perform exactly the same economic role.
- C) Sea lanes prevent cities from developing.
- D) Refrigerated shipping has no relationship to food trade.

GED-SOC14-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows changes in U.S. household spending patterns.

Year: 1950, 1980, 2010

Food at home: 22%, 14%, 8%

Health care: 4%, 7%, 16%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The share spent on food at home decreased while the share spent on health care increased.
- B) Spending shares for food at home and health care both decreased.
- C) Health care had the higher share in 1950.
- D) Food at home had the same share in all three years.

GED-SOC14-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires public universities to follow open admissions standards for in-state students who complete certain high school courses and meet a minimum grade requirement. Universities may set additional standards for selective programs, but they must apply those standards consistently.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Public education access rules can combine broad eligibility with consistent program standards.
- B) Public universities may change standards differently for each applicant without rules.
- C) State constitutions cannot address public education.
- D) Selective programs must admit every applicant automatically.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC14-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Treating tax breaks as part of fiscal oversight — Explanation: Tax exemptions, deductions, and credits reduce revenue, so reviewing them helps lawmakers evaluate fiscal effects.

GED-SOC14-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Steel panels have the higher tariff as a share of pre-tariff price. — Explanation: Steel panels have a tariff of \$75 on \$500, or 15%; solar batteries have \$40 on \$800, or 5%.

GED-SOC14-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Debate over strategies for advancement under segregation — Explanation: The source compares different educational and political strategies used in response to segregation.

GED-SOC14-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Easier transportation and access to water routes — Explanation: Factories cluster where the highway crosses rivers, making movement of goods and resources easier.

GED-SOC14-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: It helps officials understand long-term financial effects before changing benefits. | It connects retirement policy to obligations paid over time. — Explanation: Actuarial reviews estimate future pension obligations and contributions.

GED-SOC14-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether online privacy rules should be nationally uniform or allow stronger state action — Explanation: Source A favors one national rule, while Source B supports stronger state protections.

GED-SOC14-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Immigration contributed to labor and community development while also provoking discrimination and exclusion — Explanation: The source describes both immigrant labor and anti-Chinese violence and restrictions.

GED-SOC14-008 — Correct: D1=diversity jurisdiction; D2=state law claims — Correct Answer: D1=diversity jurisdiction; D2=state law claims — Explanation: Diversity jurisdiction can allow federal courts to hear cases between citizens of different states, while state courts hear many state-law disputes.

GED-SOC14-009 — Correct: 30 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 30 — Explanation: 2% of \$1,500 is \$30.

GED-SOC14-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Natural resource wealth can create debates over regional distribution of revenue. — Explanation: Offshore gas creates jobs and revenue debates between coastal and inland regions.

GED-SOC14-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Intergovernmental coordination across overlapping jurisdictions — Explanation: The agreements coordinate services where state, tribal, and local responsibilities overlap.

GED-SOC14-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Enrollment increased faster than the number of institutions. — Explanation: Enrollment rose from 18,000 to 96,000, while institutions rose only from 24 to 38.

GED-SOC14-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Regional public bodies may be created to manage services that cross local boundaries. — Explanation: Regional water authorities coordinate water services across city and county boundaries under state law.

GED-SOC14-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A country can benefit from one global price change while being hurt by another trade-related cost. — Explanation: Higher copper prices increase royalty revenue, but a weaker currency raises import costs.

GED-SOC14-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local governments have only the legal powers granted to them — Explanation: Counties may create penalties only when state law grants that authority.

GED-SOC14-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Disability rights activism connected civil rights claims to access in everyday public life. | Activists used legal and public-pressure strategies to seek policy change. — Explanation: Sit-ins, lawsuits, and campaigns targeted barriers in schools, transit, work, and public buildings.

GED-SOC14-017 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Coastal strip — Explanation: The coastal strip has 5 million people over 10,000 square miles, or 500 people per square mile, the highest density.

GED-SOC14-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Contract rules can link public payments to measurable results. — Explanation: Benchmarks connect contractor payments to completion dates and service quality.

GED-SOC14-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The 20-year bond has lower annual payments but higher total interest. — Explanation: The 20-year bond has a lower annual payment, \$2.8 million, but higher total interest, \$16 million.

GED-SOC14-020 — Correct: D1=sovereign immunity; D2=a limited waiver — Correct Answer: D1=sovereign immunity; D2=a limited waiver — Explanation: Sovereign immunity limits lawsuits against the state unless the state consents through a waiver.

GED-SOC14-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 45% — Explanation: Total funding is \$40 million; \$18 million from federal funds equals 45%.

GED-SOC14-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The state sets required outcomes while counties choose among approved methods. — Explanation: Counties must provide services but may choose direct operation, contracts, or shared services.

GED-SOC14-023 — Correct: 5 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 5 — Explanation: 14 days minus 9 days equals 5 additional days.

GED-SOC14-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local cultural expression can spread widely while carrying social commentary. — Explanation: Hip-hop spread beyond local neighborhoods and often addressed social issues.

GED-SOC14-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=C; T3=A — Correct Answer: T1=Regional authority; T2=Performance benchmark; T3=Sovereign immunity — Explanation: A regional authority coordinates services, a benchmark measures performance, and sovereign immunity affects lawsuits against government.

GED-SOC14-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Diversifying suppliers can reduce supply-chain risk. — Explanation: Buying from multiple countries reduces reliance on one supplier that could be disrupted.

GED-SOC14-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Managing public assets for a designated public purpose — Explanation: The lands trust dedicates lease revenue to public schools and long-term benefit.

GED-SOC14-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local fees on development should be connected to the public costs created by that development. — Explanation: The fee must be reasonably related to traffic impacts from new development.

GED-SOC14-029 — Correct: D1=service- and knowledge-based economies; D2=traditional manufacturing employment — Correct Answer: D1=service- and knowledge-based economies; D2=traditional manufacturing employment — Explanation: Redevelopment around universities, medicine, and museums reflects a shift after manufacturing losses.

GED-SOC14-030 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: \$8 million — Explanation: \$20 million + \$14 million + \$6 million = \$40 million spent; \$48 million minus \$40 million leaves \$8 million.

GED-SOC14-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Helping local governments reduce costs by cooperating on purchases — Explanation: Joint purchasing lets towns combine buying power for lower prices.

GED-SOC14-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Metro has the highest repair cost per lane mile. | Plains has the greatest number of lane miles. — Explanation: Metro has the highest repair cost at \$120,000 per lane mile, and Plains has the most lane miles at 12,000.

GED-SOC14-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Port specialization can shape nearby urban economies. — Explanation: Different port functions support different nearby services and urban economic activities.

GED-SOC14-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The share spent on food at home decreased while the share spent on health care increased. — Explanation: Food at home fell from 22% to 8%, while health care rose from 4% to 16%.

GED-SOC14-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public education access rules can combine broad eligibility with consistent program standards. — Explanation: The source combines open admissions rules with consistently applied standards for selective programs.